SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

30 October 2024 · Shift 2

76 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 14 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 15 questions

Q.1

What sum (in ₹) will earn a simple interest of ₹360 in 2 years at 16% per year rate of interest?

(A) 2250
(B) 725
(C) 1850
(D) 1125

Q.2

A shopkeeper sold an article at a profit of 4%. If he had bought the article at 5% less and sold it at ₹30 more, then he would have made a profit of 12%. What is the cost price (in ₹) of the article?

(A) 1,250
(B) 1,200
(C) 1,232
(D) 1,260

Q.3

The average weight of 14 persons out of 16 persons is 75 kg. The total weight of the remaining two persons is 48 kg more than the average weight of all 16 persons. Find the average weight of the remaining two persons.

(A) 54.6 kg
(B) 48.6 kg
(C) 60.6 kg
(D) 66.6 kg

Q.5

What will be the average of the odd numbers from 1 to 51, both inclusive?

(A) 26
(B) 26.5
(C) 25
(D) 24

Q.7

Raghu lends ₹9,600 and ₹11,800 at simple interest to two different persons for the same time at the rate of 7% per annum and 8% per annum, respectively. If he had received ₹9,696 as total interest from both, find the time period for which the amounts were lent.

(A) 12 years
(B) 6 years
(C) 10 years
(D) 8 years

Q.8

Find the ratio in which rice worth ₹7.20/kg should be mixed with rice worth ₹5.70/kg to produce a mixture worth ₹6.30/kg.

(A) 2 : 3
(B) 1 : 3
(C) 3 : 4
(D) 4 : 5

Q.9

A man travelled from Tirupati to Tirumala at the speed of 20 km/h and walked back at the speed of 4 km/h. If the whole journey took 24 hours, then find the distance (in km) between Tirumala and Tirupati.

(A) 25
(B) 80
(C) 30
(D) 20

Q.10

Aman, Bheema and Rehman play cricket, the ratio of Aman's runs to Bheema's runs and Bheema's runs to Rehman's runs is 5 : 4. They make together 549 runs. How many runs did Rehman make?

(A) 108
(B) 132
(C) 144
(D) 158

Q.12

A spherical ball of iron is to be produced. If the radius of the ball is 3 cm and weight of iron per cm^3 is 30g,what would be the weight of the ball?

(A) 1080π g
(B) 1040π g
(C) 108π g
(D) 104π g

Q.14

A policeman sees a thief at a distance of 50 m and starts chasing him at a speed of 7 m/s, while the thief runs at a speed of 5 m/s. What is the distance (in m) covered by the thief when he is caught?

(A) 125
(B) 100
(C) 175
(D) 150

Q.15

A vendor bought a certain number of bananas at 6 for ₹5 and sold them at 4 for ₹3. Find his loss percentage.

(A) 15%
(B) 12%
(C) 10%
(D) 8%

Q.16

The salary of a worker is first increased by 30% and later reduced by 28.5%. What is the net change in his salary?

(A) 8.05% increase
(B) 6.05% increase
(C) 7.05% decrease
(D) 9.05% decrease

Q.17

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 8% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 740
(B) 760
(C) 840
(D) 800

Q.18

The average of first 9 whole numbers is:

(A) 4.5
(B) 5
(C) 3
(D) 4

Q.19

A banner at a garment shop advertises 'Buy 2 and get 5'. The shopkeeper has marked all the shirts at the same amount. Gaurav was his relative and the shopkeeper gave him an additional discount of 2% on the total bill. Gaurav purchased 5 shirts and paid ₹1,274. What is the marked price of each shirt?

(A) ₹650
(B) ₹260
(C) ₹520
(D) ₹630

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.2

20 is related to 401 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 15 is related to 226. To which of the following is 18 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 - Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc.. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 364
(B) 352
(C) 325
(D) 346

Q.3

In a certain code language, ‘JUGS’ is coded as ‘3715’ and ‘GOLD’ is coded as ‘6524’. What is the code for ‘G’ in that language?

(A) 5
(B) 6
(C) 1
(D) 4

Q.4

What will come in the place of the question mark (?) in the following equation, if ‘+’ and ‘–’ are interchanged and ‘×’ and ‘÷’ are interchanged? $2 \div 90 \times 5 - 4 + 10 = ?$

(A) 35
(B) 29
(C) 30
(D) 37

Q.5

What should come in place of question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order?
CEB, GHE, KKH, ONK, ?

(A) TQN
(B) TQO
(C) SQO
(D) SQN

Q.6

In a code language, 'PINK' is coded as ‘WFUH’ and 'DORM' is coded as ‘KLYJ’. How will 'BUGI' be coded in that language?

(A) KSNE
(B) JROF
(C) KSOE
(D) IRNF

Q.7

Three statements are given, followed by two conclusions numbered 1 and 2. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some Jeans are Pants; No Pant is a Shirt; Some Shirts are T-shirts
Conclusions: 1. Some T-shirts are Shirts 2. Some T-shirts are Jeans

(A) Only conclusion 2 follows
(B) Only conclusion 1 follows
(C) Neither conclusion 1 nor 2 follows
(D) Both conclusions 1 and 2 follow

Q.8

HLTE is related to DHPA in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, VBNW is related to RXJS. To which of the following is MUXK related, following the same logic?

(A) IPSF
(B) IQTG
(C) JRUG
(D) IQSF

Q.9

AFKO is related to CHMQ in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, ILRS is related to KNTU. To which of the following is BDGI related, following the same logic?

(A) DFIK
(B) SIND
(C) RTUI
(D) HDJI

Q.10

Which of the following interchanges of signs would make the given equation correct? 96 × 8 – 15 ÷ 5 + 100 = 37

(A) ÷ and ×
(B) × and –
(C) × and +
(D) – and ÷

Q.11

In a certain code language, 'HOME' is coded as '5317' and 'EAST' is coded as '6528'.What is the code for 'E' in the given code language?

(A) 8
(B) 7
(C) 6
(D) 5

Q.13

Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G are sitting around a circular table, facing the center (but not necessarily in the same order). F is sitting second to the left of C. E is the immediate neighbour of A and C. G is sitting third to the right of D. What is the position of B with respect to G?

(A) Second to the right
(B) To the immediate right
(C) Third to the right
(D) Second to the left

Q.16

79 is related to 164 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 98 is related to 183. To which ofthe following is 112 related, following the same logic?(NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbersinto its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /subtracting /multiplying etc. to 13can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1and 3 is not allowed)

(A) 197
(B) 187
(C) 195
(D) 182

Q.18

What should come in place of the question mark (?) in the following series? 4, 10, ?, 82, 244, 730, 2188

(A) 20
(B) 38
(C) 21
(D) 28

Q.19

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All apples are mangoes. No mango is a kiwi. Conclusions: (I) No apple is a kiwi. (II) No kiwi is a mango.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Both conclusion I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.20

A, B, C, D, E, F, and G, are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Only 3 people sit between E and F when counted from the right of E. A and D are both immediate neighbours of G. B sits immediate to the right of C. Only 1 person sits between B and D. How many people sit between A and E when counted from the right of A?

(A) 4
(B) 1
(C) 2
(D) 3

General Awareness 23 questions

Q.2

Which of the following is NOT a salient feature of Fundamental Duties of the Indian Constitution?

(A) There is clear difference between Fundamental Rights and Fundamental Duties.
(B) Fundamental Duties are both civic and moral in nature.
(C) It is non-justiciable.
(D) They are enforceable by law and can be challenged in court.

Q.3

The oceanic trenches or the narrow depressions on the seafloor are formed by reason of:

(A) tsunamis
(B) thermohaline circulation
(C) tectonic activity
(D) tidal currents

Q.4

What are the three components of the empowerment model in SAPAP of SHGs?

(A) Public resource allocation, capacity building, and microfinance
(B) Social mobilisation, capital formation, and capacity building of the poor
(C) Collective empowerment, capital formation, and poverty eradication
(D) Social mobilisation, economic development, and education

Q.5

According Census 2011 of India, which of the following union territories has the second highest literacy rate?

(A) Lakshadweep
(B) Chandigarh
(C) Daman and Diu
(D) Andaman and Nicobar

Q.6

The Hindi novel 'Jhutha Sach' is written by:

(A) Yashpal
(B) Premchand
(C) Jaishankar Prasad
(D) Shrilal Shukla

Q.8

Harappa, one of the sites of the Harappan culture, was found in which of the following states of pre-independent India?

(A) Punjab
(B) Sindh
(C) United Province
(D) Balochistan

Q.9

What is the term used for the line that a raider must cross to score points in Kabaddi?

(A) Baulk line
(B) Bonus line
(C) Half line
(D) Centre line

Q.10
Which of the following states has bicameral (two houses) state legislature?

(A) Punjab
(B) Goa
(C) West Bengal
(D) Karnataka

Q.11
In the number 0.002609, the number of significant figures is _____.

(A) three
(B) four
(C) six
(D) seven

Q.12
The Indian reformer Jyotirao Phule was primarily critical of which social evil of the Indian society?

(A) Caste Discrimination
(B) Child Marriage
(C) Sati System
(D) Poverty

Q.13
Which treatise of Indian classical music was composed by Pandit Sharanga Deva?

(A) Sangeet Samay Saar
(B) Sangeet Ratnakar
(C) Sangeet Makarand
(D) Sangeet Tarang

Q.14
'Attolu Eidu' is the cultural festival of which of the following union territories?

(A) Lakshadweep
(B) Dadra and Nagar Haveli
(C) Andaman and Nicobar Islands
(D) Jammu and Kashmir

Q.15
In which year did Rohan Bopanna become world number one in the Men's Doubles category of Lawn Tennis?

(A) 2017
(B) 2023
(C) 2015
(D) 2024

Q.16
Chand Minar at Daulatabad is a 210-feet-high tapering tower divided into _____ storeys.

(A) five
(B) six
(C) four
(D) three

Q.17
Identify the personality on the basis of the given clues: i) She is an acclaimed Bharatanatyam dancer. ii) She is the recipient of Padma Shri 2016 award.

(A) Pratibha Prahlad
(B) Padmaja Reddy
(C) Aruna Mohanty
(D) Padma Sharma

Q.18
Which of the following folk dances is conducted during the Bwisagu Festival?

(A) Bihu dance
(B) Bagurumba
(C) Bhortal
(D) Jhumur

Q.19
Which of the following rivers flows through Madhya Pradesh?

(A) Sharda
(B) Bhima
(C) Shyok
(D) Betwa

Q.20
On 10 April 2023, the Government of India launched tourism infrastructure and amenities in the _____ villages through the 'Vibrant Villages Programme'.

(A) Border
(B) Desert
(C) Hill
(D) Coastal

Q.21
Who is National Security Advisor of India as of July 2023?

(A) Sanjeev Sanyal
(B) Ajit Doval
(C) Rajnath Singh
(D) Rajiv Gauba

Q.22
Which of the following is a natural indicator for acid and base?

(A) Algae
(B) China rose
(C) Curry tree
(D) Fungi

Q.23
Which port situated at the head of Gulf of Kutch has helped to reduce the pressure at Mumbai port?

(A) Kolkata
(B) Kochi
(C) Haldia
(D) Kandla

Q.24
Cyanobacteria belong to the domain of:

(A) Decomposers
(B) Producers
(C) Primary Consumers
(D) Tertiary Consumers

Q.25
According to National Multidimensional Poverty Index 2023 (A Progress Review), what is the percentage of the total population who are multidimensionally poor (Headcount Ratio) in Bihar state?

(A) 45.98%
(B) 36.12%
(C) 40.54%
(D) 33.76%

English Language and Comprehension 23 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM for the underlined word in the given sentence. He is a "lazy" person.

(A) perfect
(B) casual
(C) hardworking
(D) popular

Q.2
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word from the given sentence. The explorer's adventuros spirit led to the discovery of an ancient civilisation.

(A) Ancient
(B) Adventuros
(C) Discovery
(D) Explorer's

Q.3
In the following sentence the underlined part contains an error. Alternatives to the underlined part are given as options. Select the correct alternative. Wolfia is the "tiny" plant in the world.

(A) tinier
(B) tiniest
(C) more tiny
(D) most tiny

Q.4

Identify the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word in brackets. Her candid remarks were a (refreshing) change from the usual diplomatic responses.

(A) Invigorating
(B) Revitalising
(C) Stale
(D) Bracing

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Abolished
(B) Adverse
(C) Annoyed
(D) Abodomen

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. I started feeling tired as I had been working for a long time and so I decided to “call the day”.

(A) be called a day
(B) call off the day
(C) be a day for calling
(D) call it a day

Q.7

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error in phrasal verb. Gita got onto / the book / she was reading / this morning.

(A) she was reading
(B) the book
(C) Gita got onto
(D) this morning

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment without changing its meaning in the given sentence. Entrepreneurial “endeavours drive economic growth” and innovation, empowering individuals to bring their ideas to fruition.

(A) ventures contribute to economic flourishing
(B) pursuits manipulates economic success
(C) actions spur economic recession
(D) projects discourage economic prosperity

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The farmer stood by the roadside stand to sell his _____.

(A) volume
(B) produce
(C) productivity
(D) consequence

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. I had to choose the “best of” the two options available.

(A) best than
(B) better than
(C) good of
(D) better of

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Sree did not go to work today, as she was “feeling a bit under the weather.”

(A) feeling nervous
(B) feeling ill
(C) feeling excited
(D) feeling tired

Q.14

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. My mother said / that the thief / Ramesh will learnt / his lesson soon.

(A) My mother said
(B) his lesson soon.
(C) that the thief
(D) Ramesh will learnt

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Please turn off the lights _____ leaving the house.

(A) between
(B) before
(C) during
(D) amid

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The family members described their dream home's architectural “elegance”.

(A) fortitude
(B) grandiosity
(C) gleam
(D) coarseness

Q.17

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. After the match, / the stadium was the messiest / it’s ever been.

(A) No Error
(B) the stadium was the messiest
(C) it’s ever been
(D) After the match

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. He is going to _____ the campaign against excessive use of _____ in local production units.

(A) protest
(B) spice
(C) lead
(D) combat

Q.19

Select the most appropriate adjective to fill in the blank. According to the chairman, his proposal was _____ than Mr. Jackson’s.

(A) worst
(B) ill
(C) worse
(D) bad

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. James is just an old “eccentric.”

(A) Follower
(B) Ordinary
(C) Cranky
(D) Humble

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Enlightenment, sometimes known as the 'Age of Reason', is described as the period of (1)_____ scientific, political, and philosophical debate that characterised European culture (2) _____ the 'long' 18th century: from the late 17th century until the end of the Napoleonic Wars in 1815. This was an era of an enormous (3) _____ in thinking and reason, which historian Roy Porter describes as 'decisive in the formation of modernity'. Centuries of custom and tradition were (4) _____ in favour of exploration, individuality, tolerance, and scientific (5) _____, all of which contributed to the formation of the 'modern world'.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1..

(A) cautions
(B) rigorous
(C) auspicious
(D) malicious

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Enlightenment, sometimes known as the 'Age of Reason', is described as the period of (1)_____ scientific, political, and philosophical debate that characterised European culture (2) _____ the 'long' 18th century: from the late 17th century until the end of the Napoleonic Wars in 1815. This was an era of an enormous (3) _____ in thinking and reason, which historian Roy Porter describes as 'decisive in the formation of modernity'. Centuries of custom and tradition were (4) _____ in favour of exploration, individuality, tolerance, and scientific (5) _____, all of which contributed to the formation of the 'modern world'.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2..

(A) above
(B) over with
(C) along with
(D) throughout

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Enlightenment, sometimes known as the 'Age of Reason', is described as the period of (1)_____ scientific, political, and philosophical debate that characterised European culture (2) _____ the 'long' 18th century: from the late 17th century until the end of the Napoleonic Wars in 1815. This was an era of an enormous (3) _____ in thinking and reason, which historian Roy Porter describes as 'decisive in the formation of modernity'. Centuries of custom and tradition were (4) _____ in favour of exploration, individuality, tolerance, and scientific (5) _____, all of which contributed to the formation of the 'modern world'.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3..

(A) shield
(B) shift
(C) embed
(D) secure

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Enlightenment, sometimes known as the 'Age of Reason', is described as the period of (1)_____ scientific, political, and philosophical debate that characterised European culture (2) _____ the 'long' 18th century: from the late 17th century until the end of the Napoleonic Wars in 1815. This was an era of an enormous (3) _____ in thinking and reason, which historian Roy Porter describes as 'decisive in the formation of modernity'. Centuries of custom and tradition were (4) _____ in favour of exploration, individuality, tolerance, and scientific (5) _____, all of which contributed to the formation of the 'modern world'.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4..

(A) discarded
(B) dejected
(C) defrosted
(D) demean

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The Enlightenment, sometimes known as the 'Age of Reason', is described as the period of (1)_____ scientific, political, and philosophical debate that characterised European culture (2) _____ the 'long' 18th century: from the late 17th century until the end of the Napoleonic Wars in 1815. This was an era of an enormous (3) _____ in thinking and reason, which historian Roy Porter describes as 'decisive in the formation of modernity'. Centuries of custom and tradition were (4) _____ in favour of exploration, individuality, tolerance, and scientific (5) _____, all of which contributed to the formation of the 'modern world'.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5..

(A) slacken
(B) doodle
(C) endeavour
(D) shirk

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**
Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**			

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**
Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**			

General Awareness

Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**	Q.8 **(A)**
Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(A)**
Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.1 · Answer (D) 1125

P = SI × 100/(R × T) = 360 × 100/(16 × 2) = ₹1,125.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 1,250

With cost price x, the selling price is 1.04x. Bought at 0.95x and sold at 1.04x + 30 for a 12% profit: 1.04x + 30 = 1.12 × 0.95x = 1.064x, so 0.024x = 30 and x = ₹1,250.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 60.6 kg

The 14 weigh 14 × 75 = 1,050 kg. If the average of all 16 is A, the other two weigh A + 48, so 16A = 1,050 + A + 48 and A = 73.2. The two weigh 121.2 kg, an average of 60.6 kg.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 26

The odd numbers from 1 to 51 are evenly spaced, so their average is (1 + 51)/2 = 26.

Q.7 · Answer (B) 6 years

Interest a year = 9,600 × 7% + 11,800 × 8% = 672 + 944 = ₹1,616. 9,696/1,616 = 6 years.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 2 : 3

By alligation: (6.30 − 5.70) : (7.20 − 6.30) = 0.60 : 0.90 = 2 : 3.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 80

d/20 + d/4 = 24, so 6d/20 = 24 and d = 80 km.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 144

A : B = 5 : 4 and B : C = 5 : 4, so A : B : C = 25 : 20 : 16, which sums to 61. 549/61 = 9, so Rehman made 16 × 9 = 144 runs.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 1080π g

Volume = (4/3)π × 3^3 = 36π cm^3, so the ball weighs 36π × 30 = 1080π g.

Q.14 · Answer (A) 125

The policeman gains 7 − 5 = 2 m/s, so he closes the 50 m in 25 s. In that time the thief runs 5 × 25 = 125 m.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 10%

12 bananas cost ₹10 and sell for ₹9: a loss of ₹1 on ₹10, or 10%.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 7.05% decrease

1.30 × (1 − 0.285) = 1.30 × 0.715 = 0.9295, so the salary falls by 7.05%.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 800

SI = 2,500 × 8 × 4/100 = ₹800.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 4

The first 9 whole numbers are 0 to 8; their average is (0 + 8)/2 = 4.

Q.19 · Answer (A) ₹650

'Buy 2 and get 5' means paying for 2 shirts and getting 5. With the extra 2% off, 2M × 0.98 = 1,274, so 2M = 1,300 and M = ₹650.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.2 · Answer (C) 325

Each number is related to its square plus 1: 20^2 + 1 = 401 and 15^2 + 1 = 226. Likewise 18^2 + 1 = 325.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 5

G is the only letter in both words and 5 the only digit in both codes, so G = 5.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 30

After interchanging the signs: 2 × 90 ÷ 5 + 4 − 10 = 36 + 4 − 10 = 30.

Q.5 · Answer (D) SQN
First letters move 4 places forward (C, G, K, O, so next S); second and third letters move 3 forward (E, H, K, N, so Q; B, E, H, K, so N): SQN.

Q.6 · Answer (D) IRNF
The letters move +7, –3, +7, –3: PINK → WFUH and DORM → KLYJ. So BUGI → IRNF.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Only conclusion 1 follows
'Some Shirts are T-shirts' converts to 'some T-shirts are Shirts', so 1 follows. Nothing links T-shirts to Jeans, so 2 does not follow.

Q.8 · Answer (B) IQTG
Each letter moves 4 places back, wrapping round before A: HLTE → DHPA and VBNW → RXJS. So MUXK → IQTG.

Q.9 · Answer (A) DFIK
Each letter moves 2 places forward: AFKO → CHMQ and ILRS → KNTU. So BDGI → DFIK.

Q.10 · Answer (A) ÷ and ×
Interchanging ÷ and ×: 96 ÷ 8 – 15 × 5 + 100 = 12 – 75 + 100 = 37.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 5
E is the only letter in both words and 5 the only digit in both codes, so E = 5.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Second to the left
Going round to each person's left (clockwise, as they face the centre) the order is C, G, F, B, D, A, E: F second to C's left, E between A and C, and G third to D's right. B is second to the left of G.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 197
The second number is the first plus 85: 79 + 85 = 164 and 98 + 85 = 183. Likewise 112 + 85 = 197.

Q.18 · Answer (D) 28
Each term is 3 times the one before minus 2: 4 × 3 – 2 = 10, 10 × 3 – 2 = 28, 28 × 3 – 2 = 82, and so on to 2188.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Both conclusion I and II follow
Every apple is a mango and no mango is a kiwi, so no apple is a kiwi (I). 'No mango is a kiwi' converts to 'no kiwi is a mango' (II). Both follow.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 3
Going round to each person's right (anticlockwise, as they face the centre) from E the order is E, D, G, A, F, C, B: three people between E and F, G between A and D, B to C's right and one person, E, between B and D. To the right of A come F, C and B before E: three.

General Awareness

Q.2 · Answer (D) They are enforceable by law and can be challenged in court.
The Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) are non-justiciable: no court can enforce them directly, so being enforceable and open to challenge in court is not one of their features.

Q.3 · Answer (C) tectonic activity
Oceanic trenches form where one tectonic plate sinks beneath another (subduction), as at the Mariana Trench.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Social mobilisation, capital formation, and capacity building of the poor
SSC's key gives social mobilisation, capital formation and capacity building of the poor. SAPAP, the UNDP-backed South Asia Poverty Alleviation Programme, organised the poor into self-help groups that build up their own savings and are trained to run them.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Daman and Diu
In the 2011 Census Lakshadweep had the highest literacy rate among the union territories, and Daman and Diu (about 87%) the second highest.

Q.6 · Answer (A) Yashpal
'Jhutha Sach', a two-part Hindi novel about the Partition, was written by Yashpal.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Punjab
Harappa, on the Ravi, lies in the old Montgomery district of Punjab (now Sahiwal, in Pakistan); Daya Ram Sahni excavated it in 1921.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Baulk line
A raider must cross the baulk line in the opponents' half for the raid to count; the bonus line, further in, earns an extra point.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Karnataka
Six states have a Legislative Council as well as an Assembly: Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh. Punjab, Goa and West Bengal have only an Assembly.

Q.11 · Answer (B) four
Leading zeros only place the decimal point and are not significant; 2, 6, 0 and 9 are, so there are four.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Caste Discrimination
Jyotirao Phule fought caste discrimination above all: his 'Gulamgiri' (1873) attacked the caste system, and his Satyashodhak Samaj, founded the same year, worked for the lower castes.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Sangeet Ratnakar
Sharngadeva's 'Sangita Ratnakara', written in the 13th century, is a classic treatise on Indian music and dance.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Lakshadweep
SSC's key gives Lakshadweep, the union territory whose islanders, almost all of them Muslim, keep the Eid festivals as their chief celebrations.

Q.15 · Answer (D) 2024
Rohan Bopanna reached world No. 1 in men's doubles in January 2024, at 43 the oldest player to get there for the first time, and won the Australian Open with Matthew Ebden that month.

Q.16 · Answer (C) four
The Chand Minar, a 15th-century Bahmani victory tower at Daulatabad, rises in four storeys.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Pratibha Prahlad
Pratibha Prahlad, a Bharatanatyam dancer from Karnataka, received the Padma Shri in 2016.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Bagurumba
Bagurumba is the Bodo dance performed at Bwisagu, the Bodo new-year festival in Assam.

Q.19 · Answer (D) Betwa
The Betwa rises in Madhya Pradesh and flows into Uttar Pradesh to join the Yamuna. The Sharda runs along the India-Nepal border, the Bhima through Maharashtra and Karnataka, and the Shyok through Ladakh.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Border
The Vibrant Villages Programme, launched by Home Minister Amit Shah at Kibithoo in Arunachal Pradesh on 10 April 2023, develops villages along India's northern border.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Ajit Doval
Ajit Doval has been India's National Security Advisor since 2014.

Q.22 · Answer (B) China rose
An indicator made from China rose (hibiscus) petals turns acids dark pink (magenta) and bases green.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Kandla
Kandla, at the head of the Gulf of Kutch, was developed after Partition, when Karachi went to Pakistan, to ease the load on Mumbai port.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Producers
Cyanobacteria (blue-green algae) photosynthesise and make their own food, so they are producers.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 33.76%
NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index 2023 puts 33.76% of Bihar's population in multidimensional poverty in 2019-21, down from 51.89% in 2015-16.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) hardworking
'Lazy' means unwilling to work; its opposite is 'hardworking'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Adventuros
The correct spelling is 'adventurous'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) tiniest
'The … in the world' compares one thing with all others, so the superlative is needed: 'the tiniest plant in the world'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Stale
'Refreshing' means pleasantly new and different; its opposite is 'stale'. The other three are near-synonyms.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Abodomen
The correct spelling is 'abdomen'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) call it a day
The idiom is 'call it a day': to stop working for the day.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Gita got onto
'Get onto' means to climb onto something or to contact someone; reading a book through is 'getting through' it (or, becoming absorbed in it, 'getting into' it).

Q.9 · Answer (A) ventures contribute to economic flourishing
'Ventures' are 'endeavours', to 'contribute to' something is near to 'driving' it, and 'flourishing' matches 'growth', so the meaning is kept; the others reverse it ('recession', 'discourage') or break the grammar ('pursuits manipulates').

Q.11 · Answer (B) produce
A farmer's 'produce' is what he grows, here sold at a roadside stand.

Q.12 · Answer (D) better of
Between two, the comparative is used: 'the better of the two options'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) feeling ill
To be 'under the weather' is to feel slightly ill.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Ramesh will learnt
'Will' is followed by the base form of the verb: 'will learn', not 'will learnt'.

Q.15 · Answer (B) before
The lights go off ahead of leaving: 'before leaving the house'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) coarseness
'Elegance' is refined grace; its opposite is 'coarseness'. 'Fortitude' is courage, and 'grandiosity' and 'gleam' are not opposites.

Q.17 · Answer (A) No Error
'It's' here stands for 'it has': 'the messiest it has ever been' is correct, so there is no error.

Q.18 · Answer (C) lead
'Lead' fits both blanks: to 'lead' (head) the campaign, against the excessive use of 'lead', the toxic metal.

Q.19 · Answer (C) worse
With 'than' the comparative is needed, and the comparative of 'bad' is 'worse'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Cranky
An 'eccentric' is an odd, unconventional person; 'cranky', in its sense of strange or odd, is the closest of the options.

Q.21 · Answer (B) rigorous
A period of 'rigorous', that is thorough and demanding, scientific, political and philosophical debate.

Q.22 · Answer (D) throughout
The debate ran 'throughout' the long 18th century, from the late 17th century to 1815.

Q.23 · Answer (B) shift
The era saw an enormous 'shift', or change, in thinking and reason, which shaped modernity.

Q.24 · Answer (A) discarded
Centuries of custom and tradition were 'discarded', thrown aside, in favour of exploration and tolerance.

Q.25 · Answer (C) endeavour
'Scientific endeavour', that is scientific effort and inquiry, goes with exploration, individuality and tolerance.

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